BUILT YOUNG, DESIGN PHASE

Session 2: Test with real people.

Today you meet your users, then watch someone use your app.



Today's objectives

By the end of today, you can...

- Explain what a persona is
- Make a primary persona and one more
- Write test tasks as goals
- Run a test without helping
- Pick the core flows worth testing

Today's principles

Principle 1

Start with people

Your user isn't you. Design for how they think.

Ask yourself

Who is this for, and how do they think?

Principle 5

Test and learn

You don't know if it works until someone else tries it.

Ask yourself

Where did someone get stuck, and why?

What's a persona?

A made-up person, based on real people, who stands for a group of your users.

Every persona has

- Who they are
- Goals
- Needs
- Pain points
- How they think

Meet Maya



Maya, 16

Plays soccer and lifts 3 times a week.

> "I just want to log it and get back to my set."

Goal

Get stronger before the season.

Needs

To log a set in seconds.

Pain point

Forgets what she lifted last time.

How she thinks

In sets and reps, with her phone in one hand.

Meet Sam



Sam, 19

New to the gym this year.

> "I don't even know what I'm supposed to write down."

Goal

Make the gym a habit.

Needs

To know what to do next.

Pain point

Gives up when an app asks too much.

How he thinks

In exercises, not sets.

Design for how they think

Your screens should match how your personas think.

Maya	Logs between sets, with one hand.	→	**Big buttons. Repeat the last set in one tap.**
Sam	Doesn't know what to log.	→	**Suggest a starter workout.**

Your turn: who are your personas?

Start with your primary user, then one more.

- Who are they?
- What are their goals?
- What do they need?
- What gets in their way?
- How do they think?

Then

Run Prompt 4 in Claude Design.

Why we test

You know how your app works.

Your users don't.

When people get stuck, they blame themselves. It's almost always the design.

A test in 6 steps

1

Pick a core flow

2

Write tasks as goals

3

Find a tester who matches your persona

4

Read the script

5

Watch, don't help

6

Write down where they got stuck

Weak task vs strong task

Weak

"Tap the plus button and add a workout."

It tells them where to tap.

Strong

"You just finished at the gym. Record what you did."

It gives a goal, in a real moment.

Don't use the words on your buttons.

The hardest part: stay quiet

Don't help.

If they ask what to do, say:

"What would you try?"

Let's test it

The task

"You just finished at the gym. You did 3 sets of 10 squats. Record what you did."

Tester

Open the link and share your screen.

Everyone else

Write down where they pause.

Link **built-young-design-phase.vercel.app/workout-log**

What did we notice?

1. Where did they pause?

2. What did they expect to happen?

3. What would you change?

Test your core flows

You can't test everything. Start with the flows your app can't work without.

Epic 1	**Log a workout**	Test this first
Epic 2	**Get started**	
Epic 3	**See your progress**	

MVP cut line

Epic 4	Share with friends	Later

Your turn: pick your core flows

Which flows will you test?

1. Name your core loop.
2. Pick the 1 or 2 flows in it.
3. Run Prompt 5: your test guide.

Check every task

No button words. No tapping instructions.

Your homework

Due Sunday at 1 PM ET, before Session 3.



Step 1

Tidy up your flows

The flows, not the looks. Stay in grey wireframes.



Step 2

Test with 2 or 3 people

People who match your personas.



Step 3

Make changes

Fix what tripped up your testers.